

Cover Letter — Palo Alto Networks

IT Field Engineer - ANZ

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the IT Field Engineer position at Palo Alto Networks. The mission to protect our digital way of life through innovation and cutting-edge technology aligns with my passion for building secure, resilient IT environments — and the remote-first flexibility makes this an exceptional opportunity.

My background combines infrastructure engineering with a security-first mindset developed through hands-on compliance work. At CapGemini (Department of Education Victoria), I drive Azure cloud adoption aligned to the Essential 8 mitigation framework, ensuring that infrastructure across a 660,000+ user environment meets Australia's most rigorous cybersecurity standards. This includes evaluating and hardening configurations, implementing security controls, and ensuring compliance across M365, Entra ID, and Azure services.

As a Tier-3 escalation engineer, I troubleshoot complex security-adjacent issues: identity conflicts in Active Directory/Entra ID synchronisation, mail-flow vulnerabilities in Exchange Hybrid, and federation trust misconfigurations. I also developed PnP PowerShell MFA compliance audits across 200+ SharePoint sites — a proactive security initiative that identified and remediated authentication gaps.

My field engineering experience includes multi-site deployments at St John of God Health Care (100+ clinical endpoint migration) and device lifecycle management at Australia Post, where I worked across physical infrastructure, endpoint provisioning, and user support in varied environments.

Palo Alto Networks' position at the forefront of cybersecurity makes this a compelling opportunity to combine my infrastructure engineering skills with my growing security expertise. I am confident I can deliver immediate value while deepening my contribution to your security mission.

I look forward to discussing this role further.

Best regards, Sam Ludwig sam.ludwig@gmail.com | +61 405 993 245 | linkedin.com/in/sam-ludwig

Note: This cover letter should be converted to PDF before submission.